Havisha **Khurana**

PhD Candidate

College of Education, University of Oregon

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Drawing from my experiences as an educator in a low-income school, I am passionate about evidence-based policies that promote a fair and inclusive education system. I use descriptive quantitative analysis and econometrics methods to study the impact of policies on students with disabilities and other underserved populations.

Education

University of Oregon

Ph.D. Quantitative Research Methods in Education — *2021-Expected 2027*

- GPA: 4.12
- Specialization in Educational Data Science with R
- Advisor: Prof. David Liebowitz

University of Oregon

M.S. Economics — *2022-2025*

- GPA: 4.22
- Advisor: Prof. Glen Waddell
- Thesis Title: Optimal Special Education Identification Under State Finance Policies

St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi

B.S. (H) Mathematics — *2014-2017*

Researh Experience

National R&D Center to Improve Education for Secondary English Learners - Dr. Ilana Umansky and Dr. Karen Thomspon

Exploring Integrated English Language Development programs in Oregon — *2025*

- Co-developed the research question and methods; led quantative analysis for the project

Getting Down to Facts III, SCALE Initiative, Stanford University - Dr. Ilana Umansky

Differences in California Reclassification Effects by Criterion and Threshold Level — *2025*

- Co-developed the research question and methods; compiled data on district reclassification crtierias; used descriptive statistics and fuzzy regression discontinuity design to estimate the effect of an additional academic criterion on students's outcomes

iMentor - Dr. Kallen Tsikalas

iMentor College: Mapping Text-Prompt Response Rate and Pair Connection — *2025*

- Refined stakeholders' research questions; developed the researc plan; conducted literature review on pair/small-group mentoring program models and their effects on student outcomes; harmonized all primary data files into a meta-dataset; used descriptive statistics to highlight usage trends

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

Effects of administrative directions on the DIBELS8 nonsense-word fluency (NWF) subtest — *2025*

- Co-developed the analytical plan; performed multi-level linear regression for a repeated measures RCT design; drafted a technical report

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

Investigating the effects of literacy tutoring on the reading achievement of struggling readers in grades K-2 during COVID-19 school closure — *2024/2025*

- Developed the research design using several matching-on-observable estimators to identify the causal effect of the tutoring program on struggling readers; reported findings to district leaders

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

Spanish Instructions as a DIBELS® Accommodation — *2024*

- Performed regression and power analysis as outlined in the pre-analysis plan for an RCT design; drafted a technical report.

Edunomics Lab, Georgetown University - Maggie Cicco

Special education expenditures in Oregon *2024*

- Compiled administrative data on student membership, student state achievement, and special education expenditure for 2022

Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon - Dr. David Liebowitz

Who are the students school frequently suspend? *2023*

- Compiled analysis-ready data file using administrative data; performed statistical analysis using multi-level regression models, variation decomposition analysis, and unsupervised machine learning clustering algorithm

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

Comparing Reading Growth Trajectories Pre- and Post-COVID-19-related School Closure in a Large Urban District *2023*

- Employed multi-level piecewise growth models to estimate shifts in average reading scores and examine demographic heterogeneity in a large urban district panel sample during the years impacted by COVID-19 school closures; summarized findings in a executive report and presented results to district administration

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

DIBELS8 Secure form creation *2023*

- Automated test form generation and quality control checks for alternative DIBELS8 subtests using R

Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon - Dr. David Liebowitz

Rethinking principal effects on student outcomes *2022*

- Wrangled administrative data on discipline, high-school graduation, and college outcomes for estimating principle effects using value-added-models on students' long-term outcomes

Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon - Dr. Gina Biancarosa and Dr. Patrick Kennedy

Three-year analysis of DIBEL8 Reading Assessment Data *2022*

- Summarized, visualized, and created Shiny dashboards to describe changes in student reading outcomes across COVID-19 school closure phases for internal use; conducted comprehensive literature review on the early evidence of learning growth changes related to COVID-19 pandemic for internal purposes

Teaching Experience

EDUC 641/643/645: Applied Statistics in Education and Human Services (Discussion Session)

Sequence of 3 In-Person, Graduate-Level Classes: Main Instructor/TA *2022-24*

EDLD 312: Effective Leadership Decision-making

Synchronous, Undergraduate-Level: TA *2022*

EDLD 313: Program Evaluation for Future Leaders

In-Person, Undergraduate-Level: TA *2022*

EDLD 411: Examining Leadership Effectiveness through Professional Development

Asynchronous, Undergraduate-Level: TA *2021*

STEM tutoring sessions

Synchronous, Middle And High School-Level *2019-20*

Mathematics school teacher

In-Person, Middle And High School-Level *2017-19*

Employment History

Prof. Gina Biancarosa, Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Oregon

Research Assistant *Summer 2022/23/24/25; Winter/Spring 2026*

National R&D Center to Improve Education for Secondary English Learners

Research Assistant *Fall 2025*

Prof. David Liebowitz, Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon

Research Assistant *2021-2024*

Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon

Teaching Assisstant *2021-2025*

OpenLinks Foundation

Teaching Resource Consultant *2019-2021*

LIDO Learning

Teaching Consultant *2019-2020*

Teach for India, Sunrise English Medium School

School Teacher *2017-2019*

Products

Working Papers

Khurana, H., Liebowitz, D.D. Who are the Students School Frequently Suspend?.
Umansky, I., Khurana, H. Effect of Academic Criteria in English Learner Reclassification Policy.
Biancarosa, G., Gallo,J., Lussier,C., Khurana, H., Kennedy, P. Kindergarten phonemic knowledge: A psychometric comparison of phonemic awareness and letter-sound correspondence task.
Thompson, K., Khurana, H., Bovee, J. Integerated English Language Development Program in Oregon.

Reports

Khurana, H., Otterstedt, J., Biancarosa, G., Kennedy, P. (forthcoming). DIBELS® 8 Nonsense Word Fluency: Comparison of Administration Directions. Technical Report.
Kennedy, P., Khurana, H. (forthcoming). A Comparison of DIBELS 8th Edition Composite Score Percentile Ranks and Zones of Growth. Technical Report.
Khurana, H. (September, 2025). iMentor College: Mapping Text-Prompt Response Rate and Pair Connection. Executive Report and Internal Brief.
Biancarosa, G., Khurana, H., Kennedy, P. (October, 2025). Access to and Effect of Tutoring Programs in a Large Urban District. District Presentation.
Khurana, H., Otterstedt, J., Biancarosa, G., Kennedy, P. (February, 2025). Spanish Instructions as a DIBELS® Accommodation. Technical Report.
Biancarosa, G., Khurana, H., Kennedy, P. (December, 2023). Comparing Reading Growth Trajectories Pre- and Post-COVID-19-related School Closure in a Large Urban District. District Presentation.

Conference Presentations

Khurana, H. (October, 2025). iMentor College: Mapping Text-Prompt Response Rate and Pair Connection. Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness. Illinois, Chicago.
Khurana, H. (October, 2025). Characterizing Variation in Special Education Revenues and Expenditures Using Oregon's School Funding Formula. Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness. Illinois, Chicago.
Khurana, H. (October, 2025). Leveraging Research for Philanthropic Strategy Setting: iMentor College: Mapping Text-Prompt Response Rate and Pair Connection. Grantmakers for Educations. Memphis, Tennessee.
Biancarosa, G., Gallo,J., Lussier,C., Khurana, H., Kennedy, P. (July, 2025). Kindergarten phonemic knowledge: A psychometric comparison of phonemic awareness and letter-sound correspondence task. The Society for the Scientific Study of Reading. Calgary, Canada.
Khurana, H., Liebowitz, D.D. (November, 2024). Who are the Students School Frequently Suspend?. Association for Public Policy and Management. National Harbor, Maryland.
Khurana, H., Liebowitz, D.D. (May, 2024). Who are the Students School Frequently Suspend?. Graduate Research Forum, University of Oregon. Eugene, OR.
Khurana, H., Liebowitz, D.D. (March, 2024). Who are the Students School Frequently Suspend?. Association for Education Finance & Policy. Baltimore, MD.
Khurana, H., Lee, S. (May, 2023). COVID-19 Related School Closure and Reading Outcomes. Graduate Research Forum, University of Oregon. Eugene, OR.
Klaas, M., Khurana. H. (May, 2022). Diversity, Expenditure, and Achievement in US Public Schools. Graduate Research Forum, University of Oregon. Eugene, OR.

Awards

2025	Summer Graduate Student Fellowship - Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE).	*$8,000*
2025	Lorraine Moe Davis Scholarship and the College of Education Scholarship - College of Education.	*$6,380*
2025	Harvey E Lee Graduate Scholarship - University of Oregon.	*$3,000*
2025	Golden Egg Innovator Awards - Office of the Vice President for Research and Innovation, University of Oregon.	
2024	Innovation Faculty Research Award (Awarded to Prof. David Liebowitz for our co-led project on school discipline) - Office of the Vice President for Research and Innovation, University of Oregon.	*$10,000*
2024	Lorraine Moe Davis Scholarship and the College of Education Scholarship - College of Education.	*$7,000*
2024	Certificate in Education Finance - Edunomics Lab, Georgetown University.	*$3,500*
2024	Education Methodology, Policy, and Leadership (EMPL) Travel Grant - Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon.	*$1,000*
2024	Research Transparency and Reproducibility Training (RT2) funding - Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences (BITSS).	*$700*
2024	Outstanding Poster - Graduate Student Research Forum, University of Oregon.	*$300*
2024	National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP) Data Training - Department of Education, USA.	
2023	Lillyan A Barry Scholarship - University of Oregon.	*$3,600*
2023	Education Methodology, Policy, and Leadership (EMPL) Travel Grant - Department of Education Studies, University of Oregon.	*$500*
2022	Harvey E Lee Graduate Scholarship - University of Oregon.	*$3,600*
2022	College of Education Scholarship - College of Education.	*$3,000*
2022	Outstanding Poster - Graduate Student Research Forum, University of Oregon.	*$300*
2022	Winner - USAFacts Data Visualization Competition, University of Oregon.	
2021	Graduate School Promising Scholar Award - Division of Graduate Studies, University of Oregon.	*$6,000*
2017	Teach for India Fellowship - Teach for All.	

Training

2025	State School Finance Workshop Series. EdFund.
2025	Graduate Writing Program. University of Oregon Center on Diversity and Community and Division of Graduate Studies.
2024	Certificate in Education Finance. Edunomics Lab, Georgetown University.
2024	Big Data with Arrow in R. Posit Conference.
2024	National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP) Data Training. US Department of Education and American Institutes for Research.
2024	Research Transparency and Reproducibility Training (RT2). Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences (BITSS), University of California.
Valid till 2026	Human Research - Social-Behavioral-Educational Researchers (ID 5521) - Basic and Refresher Course. Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI).
Valid till 2026	NSF/NIH Responsible Conduct of Research Training for Researchers (ID 103727). Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative (CITI).

Competencies

Methods	Statistics and Probability Theory; Generalized Regression Models; Causal Inference/Quasi-Experiment Designs; Program Evaluation; Measurement Theory and Rasch Models; Multivariate Statistics; Monte-Carlo Simulations
Data	Worked with cross-sectional, cross-sectional with repeated time, longitudinal, and text data; Data wrangling, visualization, and preparation for analyses; Data analyses and Statistical Modeling
Coding	R (Expert); Stata(Intermediate); Python (Intermediate); LaTeX (Intermediate)
Languages	Hindi (Proficient), English (Proficient)

Credits

This CV was made in R using the `vitae` package.